

Full Spectrum **WARRIOR** Ten Hammers

The Woes Of Urban Warfare

If you're sick of all the World War II games but are still fascinated by being in a war-zone, *Full Spectrum Warrior: Ten Hammers* (FSW: TH), the sequel to *Full Spectrum Warrior*, is probably for you. Set in the fictitious country Zekistan, *FSW: TH* tells the story of UN peacekeeping troops fighting for control of the only pass through the *Tien-Hamir* (the Ten Hammers)—the unforgiving mountain range that cuts through the country. After overthrowing its dictator, the forces must now fight the disgruntled citizens of the land to maintain peace in the region (hmm...sound familiar?).

You will be controlling up to four teams of four soldiers each—the Team Leader, a Rifleman, an Automatic-Rifleman and a Grenadier. The intention is quite *Commando*-ish, with strong emphasis on tactics rather than all-out shooting. In fact, it's all tactical—you'll never directly be shooting at

anyone! Instead, you'll be giving soldiers a rough "fire zone" within which they will eliminate the enemies. An addition over its predecessor is the ability to "Precision Fire" from behind your team member's shoulder—a decidedly fun feature, and quite deadly for your foes. The trade-off is that it makes your soldier more vulnerable to enemy fire, and when your men can be downed by just two or three shots, this is one feature you need to use with caution.

Visually, *FSW: TH* looks good, but there's really nothing special here that we didn't expect already. Every now and then you'll see seams in the 3D models—something that didn't go down too well with us.

With its team-strategy-meets-third-person-shooter approach, *FSW: TH* could have been a really great game, if it weren't let down by its clunky interface. Getting used to the controls is no mean task, and even then, moving your troops long distances, RTS-style,

is quite a pain. You will be commanding a maximum of four teams, and thankfully you don't need to keep switching teams to call them to a location—if you have one team selected, you can command the rest to your location in no time. However, there's no guarantee they won't be shot before they get there. The nature of the controls hampers any quick reactions you may think of having—so even if an enemy saunters into your line of fire, you'll still be fumbling while he leisurely decides on where to take cover. The lack of control over your soldiers' firing causes mounting frustration and boredom, more so when you can't have them track a moving enemy.

Try this if you're bored of the same old war-based FPS or strategy games and want to try something new, but casual gamers are bound to tire of this quite swiftly.

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Rating: 6/10

Minimum System Requirements:
 1.5 GHz processor, 256 MB RAM,
 DirectX 9.0b compatible
 GeForce 3 (or better) Graphics
 Card

Developer: Pandemic

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Distributor: E-Xpress

Interactive

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